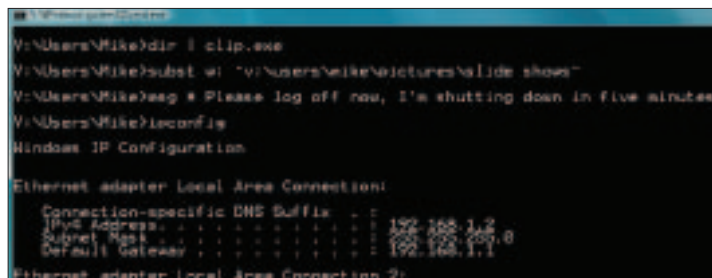
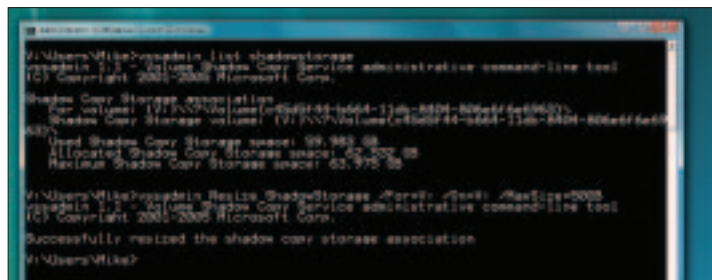


msg * Please log off now, I'm shutting down in five minutes!, press Enter and a pop-up dialogue box with your message will appear on their screens. You can reboot a remote network PC with the Shutdown command. Test by typing shutdown /r /f /m \\ComputerName /c "System will be rebooted in 30 seconds" (replace Computer Name with the name of the PC to restart).

Tip 4



Let's suppose you connect to the internet via a router. You want to access its configuration program but have forgotten the address. Open a Command Prompt window, type IPCONFIG and press Enter, then look for your network card. Beneath this will be an entry called 'Default Gateway', with an IP address. Note this down, type it into your browser — 192.168.1.1, say — and you should see the router's login dialogue appear. The IPCONFIG report will also tell you your PC's IP address (this is labelled 'IPv4 Address'). The command can also fix connectivity problems by clearing your DNS cache. Type IPCONFIG /FLUSHDNS and press Enter to give it a try.



Tip 5

Windows Vista uses the Volume Shadow Copy Service to back up your files. It is a useful but by default takes up 15 per cent of your hard disk. To alter this, click Start, type cmd.exe, right-click the link to cmd.exe that appears in the Start Menu and select Run As Administrator. Type VSSADMIN LIST SHADOWSTORAGE to gain security rights and press Enter to see how much disk space is being used. Then enter VSSADMIN RESIZE SHADOWSTORAGE /For=C: /On=C: /Maxsize=10GB to set the maximum available drive space to 10GB, or whatever you would prefer. (If your drive isn't C, change the letter accordingly.)

Tip 6

Most Command Prompt commands can be tweaked in a number of ways. Type the command's name followed by /? (as in VSSADMIN /?) to see a list of options. The DIR command is a good example. We have shown how DIR | CLIP.EXE sends a list of the current folder contents to the clipboard, but it can do a lot more. Enter DIR c:*.PDF /S | CLIP.EXE for instance, and the DIR command will search drive C: for all PDF files, including subfolders, so the clipboard will contain a list of all the PDF files on that drive. Use the /? trick with other commands to find out what they can do, but be careful. Some commands are very powerful, and can overwrite or delete as many files as they find.

